UNIT IV - GROUP COMMUNICATION

1. Basics of Group Discussion (GD)

A group discussion is a structured conversation in which a group exchanges views on a topic to reach a conclusion. It tests knowledge, communication, teamwork, leadership and listening.

- **Stages:** (1) Initiation - start with a definition or a striking fact. (2) Body - present points, respond to others. (3) Summary - close with the group view.
- **Do:** speak clearly, support points with facts, listen, respect others, invite quiet members, stay on topic.
- **Do not:** interrupt, shout, dominate, make personal remarks, or go off topic.
- **Useful phrases:** 'I agree with the point that...', 'I see it differently because...', 'To add to what he said...', 'Let us come back to the topic.'

2. Assigning Tasks to Class Groups

- Divide the class into small groups of 4 to 6 members.
- Give each group a clear task, a time limit and an expected output (a report, a chart, a presentation).
- Assign roles inside each group: leader, speaker, note-taker, timekeeper.

3. Appointing Group Leaders to Communicate

- The leader guides the discussion, divides work, keeps time and speaks for the group.
- Qualities: good listener, clear speaker, fair, calm, and able to motivate.
- A good leader shares the floor so that every member speaks.

4. Completion of Tasks Based on Communication

Tasks succeed when members share information clearly, agree on a plan, check progress and give feedback. Key steps: understand the task, plan, divide work, communicate updates, combine results, review.

5. Group Cohesion Through Communication

Cohesion means the group feels united and works well together. Open and honest communication builds trust; respectful disagreement, shared goals, and appreciation of each member's contribution strengthen cohesion. Poor communication creates misunderstanding, conflict and wasted effort.

6. Group Presentations

- Plan together: decide the topic, main message, and who speaks on which part.
- Structure: introduction - main points - conclusion - questions.
- Practise as a team and keep to the time limit.
- Smooth hand-overs: 'Now my colleague will explain...'. Face the audience, not the screen.
- Every member should speak; support each other during questions.

7. Use of PowerPoint Presentations

- One main idea per slide; short phrases, not paragraphs.
- Large, readable font (at least 24 point for body text) and high contrast between text and background.
- Use relevant images, charts and diagrams; avoid heavy animation.
- Keep the design consistent: same fonts, colours and layout.
- Do not read the slides word for word; the slide supports you, you do not read from it.

- Start with a title slide, then an outline, content slides, a conclusion and a 'Thank you / Questions' slide.